

Canonical

'This is an ambitious project' is one of the first realizations that come to mind when one takes a look at what is probably the brightest beacon for Linux. Bug #1 on their bug tracker was opened to note that Windows had a greater share of market (and, by extension, users) under its umbrella. Whatever be your preference when it comes to choosing your operating system, it is Mark Shuttleworth (the guy who gave the world Ubuntu) and his description of the problem that make for a very telling read for a bug that was filed almost exactly 10 years ago today.

Canonical has been impressive in the way that it has started to make serious headway with manufacturers (with Linux) in being installed with

Mark Shuttleworth says:

Microsoft has a majority market share in the new desktop PC marketplace. This is a bug which Ubuntu and other projects are meant to fix. As the philosophy of the Ubuntu Project states, "Our work is driven by a belief that software should be free and accessible to all."

"Ubuntu software is free. Always was, always will be. Free software gives everyone the freedom to use it however they want and share with whoever they like. This freedom has huge benefits. At one end of the spectrum it enables the Ubuntu community to grow and share its collective experience and expertise to continually improve all things Ubuntu. At the other, we are able to give access to essential software for those who couldn't otherwise afford it – an advantage that's keenly felt by individuals and organisations all over the world."

Non-free software leaves users at the mercy of the software owner and concentrates control over the technology which powers our society into the hands of a few. Additionally, proprietary software stifles innovation, maintains artificial scarcities, and enables malicious anti-features such as DRM, surveillance, and other monopolistic practices.

This bug is widely evident in the PC industry.

Steps to repeat:

1. Visit a local PC store.
2. Attempt to buy a machine without any proprietary software.

WHAT HAPPENS:

Almost always, a majority of PCs for sale have Microsoft Windows pre-installed. In the rare cases that they come with a GNU/Linux operating system or no operating system at all, the drivers and BIOS may be proprietary.

WHAT SHOULD HAPPEN:

A majority of the PCs for sale should include only free software.